

CLINKT CASE FILE — Open Investigation Challenge (Community Edition)

Originally built for VibeHack'26 at MLDC (University of Mumbai). Now open-sourced for anyone to solve at their own pace.

What this is

Clinkt is a fictional quick-commerce company. In August 2026, something went wrong — customers kept browsing and adding items to their carts, but a growing share of those carts never turned into completed orders. Clinkt doesn't know why yet.

You're handed the same case file real hackathon participants received: a newspaper report on the disruption, and five raw datasets covering Clinkt's customers, products, browsing behaviour, orders, and inventory.

Your task: investigate what's actually happening, back your conclusion with evidence, rule out the explanations that don't hold up, and recommend what Clinkt should do about it.

You are not told what to look for, or in what order. The data is the problem statement. That's intentional — figuring out *how* to investigate is part of the challenge.

What you're given

CLINKT_CASE_FILE/

```
|
|— 00_README/
|   |— PROBLEM_STATEMENT.pdf      (the newspaper report - your case brief)
|   |— DATA_DICTIONARY.pdf
|   |— SUBMISSION_GUIDELINES.pdf  (this document)
|
|— 01_CUSTOMER/
|   |— customers.csv
|
|— 02_PRODUCT/
|   |— products.csv
|
|— 03_TRANSACTIONS/
|   |— orders.csv
|
|— 04_BEHAVIOUR/
|   |— customer_interactions.csv
|
|— 05_INVENTORY/
|   |— inventory.csv
```

Start with the newspaper — it's written as a real business-news piece, not a set of instructions. It'll give you enough to form hypotheses; the data is what lets you actually prove or disprove them.

What to build

There's no clock running and no venue — take the time you need. At minimum, your submission should include:

1. A findings report

This is the heart of your submission. Whether it's a REPORT.md, a PDF, or slides, it should cover:

- **Your hypothesis** — what you believe is happening, stated plainly
- **The evidence** — what in the data supports it, and how you found it
- **What you ruled out** — alternative explanations you tested and why they didn't hold up (this matters as much as the right answer — a hypothesis nobody tried to break isn't proven, it's just asserted)
- **Quantified business impact** — translate your finding into real numbers: lost orders, affected revenue, conversion drop, whatever's appropriate to your finding
- **Recommendations** — specific to what you found, not generic advice

2. Your working code

Notebooks, scripts, a dashboard — whatever you used to do the actual analysis. This is what lets someone (including future-you) verify how you got there.

3. A README

```
# Clinkt Investigation – [Your Name / Handle]
```

```
## Summary
```

One paragraph: what you found, and what you recommend Clinkt do about it.

```
## How to explore this
```

- Report: [link/filename]
- Analysis: [where the code lives, how to run it]

```
## Findings originally from
```

VibeHack'26, MLDC (University of Mumbai) — case designed by Swayam Jagtap.
Original challenge: github.com/swayamjagtap

Suggested repo structure

```
your-repo/
├── README.md
├── REPORT.md (or REPORT.pdf)
├── data/ (optional - reference CLINKT_CASE_FILE, or include a copy)
├── notebooks/ or src/ (your actual analysis)
└── assets/ (charts, exports, screenshots)
```

None of this is mandatory structure — organize it however makes sense for your approach. The point is that someone else could open your repo and follow your reasoning.

Tools

Use whatever you're comfortable with — Excel, Power BI, Python, R, SQL, or a mix. AI coding assistants are fair game; this was designed as a “vibe-coding” challenge from the start. Just make sure the final submission reflects your own understanding of what you found, not just what a tool told you to paste in.

Data integrity

You can clean data, handle missing values, derive new columns, aggregate, and join freely.

What you shouldn't do: invent observations, alter timestamps or prices, change IDs, fabricate transactions, or quietly drop inconvenient records. If you exclude something during analysis, say so and say why — that's part of showing your work, not a weakness to hide.

Self-evaluation checklist

There's no live judging panel for the open version, but if you want a benchmark for how strong an investigation “should” look, here's the lens the original hackathon judges used:

What to check yourself against	Why it matters
Does your output actually address the problem — not just produce charts, but reach a stated conclusion?	The most common failure mode is a lot of analysis with no actual claim at the end.
Would your interface/report let a stranger find your conclusion in under a minute?	Clarity of communication is part of the challenge, not separate from it.

What to check yourself against	Why it matters
Did you do something beyond the obvious first pass — a metric, a comparison, a framing nobody else would think to try?	Everyone gets the same data. What you do with it is the differentiator.
Is your code/repo something another person could actually follow and run?	An investigation nobody can verify isn't much of an investigation.
Can you defend your conclusion if someone pushes back on it?	If you can't explain why an alternative explanation <i>doesn't</i> fit, you probably haven't ruled it out — you've just not thought about it yet.

Attribution & sharing your work

This case was designed from scratch for VibeHack'26 — the fictional company, the newspaper, the datasets, the whole investigation, all original work. If you solve it, build a dashboard, write it up, or post about it anywhere public (GitHub, LinkedIn, a blog, a portfolio site), please credit the original source:

Case designed by Swayam Jagtap for VibeHack'26 (MLDC, University of Mumbai)

GitHub: github.com/swayamjagtap

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/swayam-jagtap

Tagging on LinkedIn or GitHub when you share your solution is genuinely appreciated — it's how a case study like this finds its next solver, and it's a small ask for a case that took real effort to build.

Don't tell us what the data says. Tell us what happened, why it happened, and how you know.